

Code of Conduct Reference Standard

Reference version with stronger reporting, conflict, investigation, and governance expectations

Field	Value
Document Owner	Chief People Officer and General Counsel
Version	2.2
Effective Date	2026-03-01
Review Cycle	Annual
Classification	Internal Control Reference

1. Purpose

This Code of Conduct establishes mandatory expectations for lawful, ethical, respectful, and professional behavior across all business activities. It provides a common framework for decision-making, reporting concerns, managing conflicts, protecting information, and preserving trust in the organization.

The Code is supported by related policies and procedures, but where uncertainty exists, personnel are expected to seek guidance before acting.

2. Scope and Applicability

This Code applies to all employees, officers, directors, temporary workers, contractors, and relevant third parties acting on behalf of the organization. It applies in the office, remotely, during travel, at client sites, at work-related events, and in electronic communications and social media where there is a work connection or reputational impact.

Business units may add more specific rules but may not adopt standards weaker than those set out in this Code.

3. Respectful Workplace and Non-Retaliation

Harassment, bullying, discrimination, violence, threats, and retaliation are prohibited. This includes conduct based on protected characteristics, abuse of authority, exclusionary behavior, humiliating conduct, and inappropriate sexual behavior or comments.

Retaliation against any person who raises a concern in good faith, participates in an investigation, or refuses to engage in misconduct is prohibited and may itself result in disciplinary action.

4. Integrity, Records, and Speaking Truthfully

Personnel must act honestly and must not falsify records, conceal relevant information, misrepresent business performance, or interfere with investigations, audits, or internal reviews.

Books, records, expenses, time entries, approvals, customer communications, and regulatory submissions must be complete, accurate, and timely.

5. Conflicts of Interest

Actual, potential, or perceived conflicts of interest must be disclosed promptly. Examples include outside employment that interferes with duties, close personal relationships affecting supervision or procurement decisions, financial interests in vendors or competitors, and personal use of corporate opportunities.

Disclosures must be reviewed and documented, and mitigation measures or recusals must be implemented where needed.

6. Gifts, Hospitality, and Improper Influence

Gifts, entertainment, and hospitality must be reasonable, infrequent, transparent, and never offered or accepted to obtain an improper business advantage. Cash or cash equivalents are prohibited except where expressly allowed by policy.

Interactions involving public officials, regulated clients, active procurement events, or distressed counterparties require heightened care and, where applicable, pre-approval.

7. Confidentiality, Data Protection, and Company Resources

Confidential, personal, and proprietary information must be protected and used only for authorized purposes. Personnel must follow applicable information-security, privacy, records-management, and technology-use requirements.

Company resources must not be used for fraud, harassment, personal commercial activity, or illegal conduct. Misuse of data, systems, or intellectual property is prohibited.

8. Reporting, Investigation, and Cooperation

Concerns may be reported to a manager, Human Resources, Legal, Compliance, Security, or the ethics hotline. Reports may be made anonymously where permitted by law.

All reports must be reviewed under documented triage and investigation procedures. Personnel are required to cooperate honestly and preserve relevant records or evidence.

9. Leadership, Training, and Governance

Managers are accountable for setting the tone, addressing misconduct promptly, escalating concerns, and ensuring employees complete required training. Significant misconduct trends and substantiated breaches must be reported to appropriate governance forums.

This Code must be acknowledged by personnel at onboarding and periodically thereafter. The organization must review this Code annually and after material regulatory or organizational changes.

10. Enforcement

Breaches of this Code may result in coaching, formal discipline, termination, removal from assignments, recovery of losses, or legal referral depending on severity and intent.